



11/03/1999 - Lima, Peru

ABOUT ME

Doctoral Researcher at the Czech Academy of Sciences and member of the Ornithology Department at the Natural History Museum of Lima. My professional background focuses on population genetics, ornithology, ecology, and conservation.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Spanish Native

English Advanced: C1

French Advanced: B2

Italian Advanced: B2

Portuguese Advanced: B2

German Advanced: B2

Chinese Advanced: B2

Quechua Advanced: B2

Czech Advanced: B2

CONTACT



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Juan Francisco Esteves

Research Biologist

EDUCATION

2024-2028 - PhD in Entomology - Jihočeská univerzita v Českých Budějovicích

- Subject: Rapid evolution in communities.
- Member of Professor Jan Hrček's laboratory.
- Working at the Biology Centre of the Academy of Sciences of the Czech Republic, České Budějovice.

2021-2023 - Master in Zoology - Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos

- Thesis: Composition, abundance and assemblage of the bird community of the secondary forests of the Peruvian Amazon. Master's thesis - UNMSM
- Average grade: 18/20 (A+)
- Thesis grade: 18/20, highest honors (A+)
- Upper fifth of the class

2016-2020 - Bachelor in Biology - Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos

- With specialization in Zoology
- Thesis: Genetic diversity, inbreeding level, and viability of *Phyllodactylus sentosus* (Squamata: Phyllodactylidae) populations. Bachelor's thesis - UNMSM.
- Average grade: 15.6/20 (A)
- Thesis grade: 19/20, highest honors (A+)
- Upper fifth of the class

WORK EXPERIENCE

2024-2025 - Visiting Researcher - James Cook University

- Fieldwork in Paluma Range National Park and Kirrama National Park during four months in Australia.

2016-2025 - Researcher - Ornithology Department of the Natural History Museum, Lima, Peru

- Member of the research group "BIOECONE"
- Fieldwork in the Peruvian Amazon (Tambopata, Madre de Dios) with Rainforest Expeditions.

2022-2023 - Research Intern - NTNU University Museum

- Research group "Holomuseomics" at the Department of Natural Science, NTNU University Museum, NTNU, Trondheim, Norway
- Funded with a NORPART scholarship
- Working with archaeological samples

2019-2022 - Teaching Assistant - Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos

- Faculty of Education, Bachelor level: "Structure, Function and Animal Diversity" during the semesters 2019-I, 2021-I & 2022-II
- Faculty of Biological Sciences, Bachelor level: "General Ecology" and "Amniotic Vertebrates" courses during the 2020-II semester

SKILLS

- Fieldwork abilities
 - Scientific collections management
 - Bird ecology research techniques
 - Bird identification
 - Bird skin preparation
 - Visual Encounter Survey
 - Camera trapping
 - Entomological surveys
 - Stock maintenance
- Laboratory abilities
 - PCR
 - Electrophoresis
 - DNA barcoding
 - aDNA laboratory
 - DNA extraction of museum specimens
 - DNA extraction of ancient samples
 - NGS library build
 - Genotyping-by-sequencing
- Informatic abilities
 - Linux
 - Python
 - R
 - QGIS
 - PCA
 - NMDS
 - Sanger sequencing data curation
 - Phylogenetic analysis
 - Genetic diversity
 - Inbreeding analyses
 - Population viability simulations
 - Population structure
 - Genome assembly
 - Biodiversity analysis
 - Statistical tests in Ecology
- Certifications
 - Certified Advanced Open Water Diver by PADI

GRANTS

International exchanges and awards

- 2025. **ESEB conference** in Barcelona, Spain, funded by the *Grantová agentura JU (GAJU) grant* (Transport, accomodation and registration covered).
- 2024. Doctoral studies at **University of South Bohemia** funded by the *ERC grant* (All costs and salary covered).
- 2023. Academic exchange semester at **University of Montreal**, Canada funded with *ELAP scholarship* (8200 CAD)
- 2022. One-year internship at **NTNU**, Norway funded with *NORPART scholarship* (134 748 NOK)
- 2021. Academic exchange semester at **Ernst-Abbe-Hochschule Jena**, Germany funded with *DAAD scholarship* (6991 Euros)
- 2020. *Research Work promotion program* to obtain the bachelor's degree (1500 peruvian soles)
- 2019. Academic exchange semester at **Benemérita Universidad Autónoma de México** (Self-funded)
- 2018. Two-week exchange course at **California State University San Marcos** from the *100K Strong in the Americas fund* of the United States Embassy in Peru (Transport and living costs)

SCIENTIFIC PRODUCTION

Scientific Articles

- 2025. Decoding the Peruvian Amazon with in situ DNA barcoding of vertebrate and plant taxa. *Scientific Data*. 10.1038/s41597-025-05697-z
- 2024. A broad overview of the avifauna of secondary forests in Peruvian Amazonia. *Folia Amazónica*. 10.24841/fa.v33i1.769
- 2024. Sunning behavior of five Accipitridae species in the Peruvian Amazon rainforest. *Wilson Journal of Ornithology*. doi.org/10.1676/23-00082
- 2024. Lack of local genetic representation in one of the regions with the highest bird species richness, the Peruvian Amazonia. *PLOS ONE*. doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0296305
- 2023. Population genomics reveals how 5 ka of human occupancy led the Lima leaf-toed gecko (*Phyllodactylus sentosus*) to the brink of extinction. *Scientific Reports*. doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-45715-x

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Some of the research projects I took part in:

- 2022-Ongoing. "Eco-evolutionary dynamics and the maintenance of organismal diversity". In charge of Jan Hrček.
- 2022. "Museomica" that seeks to sequence all the species of mammals and birds of the Peruvian Amazon. In charge of San Diego Zoo Global and the Natural History Museum of Lima..
- 2021. "Mitogenome of the Amazonian churo valued in gourmet cuisine: Genomic architecture and evolution". In charge of Rina Lastenia Ramírez Mesias.
- 2019. "The city of Lima and its impact on the biodiversity of the coastal desert: Population genomics of the Lima gecko, *Phyllodactylus sentosus*". In charge of Jorge Luis Ramirez .
- 2016-2023. "Biodiversity and Business: Documenting the Flora and Fauna of the Rainforest Expeditions SAC tourist reserve, in the Tambopata Research Center (TRC), the Bahuaja Sonene National Park and the Tambopata National Reserve, Peru". In charge of Letty Edith Salinas Sánchez.